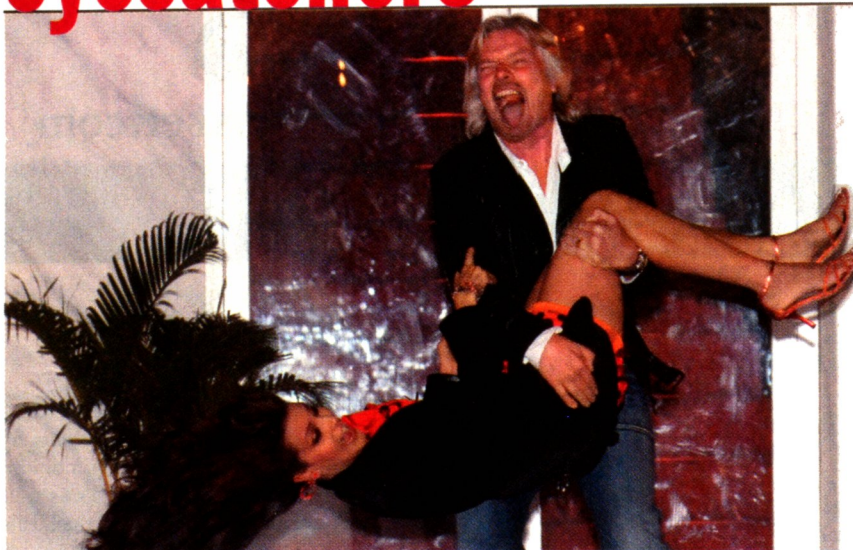




VIRGIN FALL

Here's a cosy clinch that almost went the Shilpa Shetty-Richard Gere way. Actor **Neha Dhupia** was literally swept off her feet by Sir Richard Branson, the flamboyant chairman of Virgin Group of Companies, when the duo co-starred in Channel V's 'live' Bollywood film project *Andaaz Apna Very Hatke*. From hoisting Dhupia on to his shoulders, dancing with her and catching her off-guard with an impromptu kiss, Branson played the filmy hero with ease. Another 'kissa kiss ka' waiting to happen?

Double Disaster

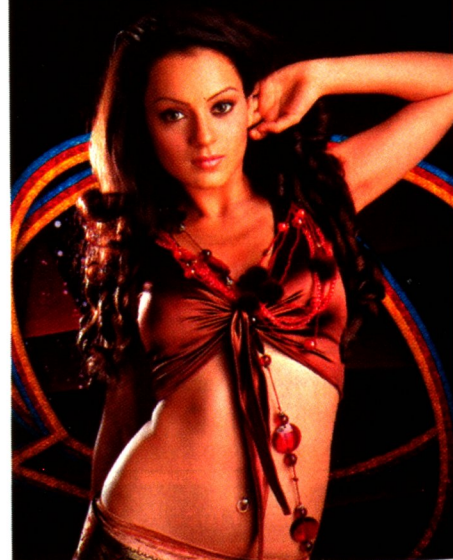
Sania Mirza may be missing in action at the Bangalore Open but the tournament has pulled off quite a coup, by roping in the talented Williams sisters. Serena, 26 and Venus, 27, walked the ramp in silk saris and gushed about all things Indian and Bollywood. While Serena said that she'd love to act in a Hindi film, Venus chose to laud Indian tennis greats. But although the siblings pack quite a punch on the court, their sari-clad look turned out to be a definite double fault.



AP PHOTO AIJAZ RAHI

JULIET RANAUT

After winning accolades for her acting on home soil, **Kangana Ranaut** is now going international. The actor may soon play Juliet in the English film *Between the Night and the Moon*, a modern-day adaptation of William Shakespeare's *Romeo and Juliet*, to be directed by Gilda Pianelli. As the world speculates about Ranaut's real life Romeo, at least the reel life hero will be revealed soon.



H K RAJASHEKAR

Board Queen

Here's a carrom player who has struck gold. Ilavazhagi, the 23-year-old daughter of an autorickshaw driver from Chennai, has returned triumphant after winning the World Carrom Championship held at the Palais des Festivals, Cannes. She is heartened by the media interest her victory has evoked. "When I won the SAARC and Commonwealth championships no one paid any attention," says the champion for whom national glory has been easier in coming than a job and sponsor.

A mouth-watering twist in the story!

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